



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Spokane Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://www.spokaneclassical.com/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Spokane Classical Christian School (SCCS) presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. Across all six categories, SCCS evidences a consistent classical orientation: explicit religious/theological foundations; a purpose centered on formation of virtue and wisdom; a curriculum built around the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a historically-grounded humanities core; pedagogical practice anchored in memory, recitation, disciplined study, and (in upper grades) rhetoric; a faculty culture described as mentors and living exemplars; and a deeply family- and church-partnered community ethos. The public materials emphasize a ministry-of-education posture, Great Commission-centered formation, covenant-community framing, and a four-day school model designed to balance family, church, and school life. There are no strong signals of secularization or a predominant shift toward non-classical, job-focused education in the public materials. The aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.

Key themes that drive the assessment - Religious/metaphysical foundations are foregrounded (Distinctly Christian Ministry of Education; Gospel-centered; Word of God; Great Commission; liturgy of life)

- The school purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, and the real/true/beautiful (formation over mere information; virtue formation; truth/goodness/beauty) via a classical frame - Curriculum centers on the liberal arts and Great Books-like structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric; historic Christian humanities; biblical-trivium; classical history sequences)
- Pedagogy employs memory work, recitation, liturgical/Contemplative elements, and upper-school rhetoric; lower-school singing/memory; and a Biblically-informed Trivium
- Faculty concept emphasizes mentors as living curriculum and model teachers; a "ministry of education" culture supports virtuous pedagogy - Parents & community are central: partnership with parents, open to visits, book/gatherings, giving, and family-church-school alignment

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit framing as a "Distinctly Christian Religious Ministry of Education" and Gospel-centered approach.
 - Emphasis on the Great Commission, Covenant Christian Community, and Effective Discipleship as core Arx Axiom principles.
 - Public materials repeatedly reference the Word of God, Jesus Christ, and worship/discipleship as central to formation.
 - Liturgical/communal language appears (e.g., "liturgy of life" and worship contexts).
 - Inter-denominational, historic-orthodox posture is stated, with caution to avoid indoctrination beyond orthodox Christianity.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: distinct Christian ministry; gospel-centered; Great Commission; Word of God; liturgy/worship; covenant Christian community; effective discipleship; orthodoxy.

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- Approximate positive keyword hits: 8–10 core items drawn directly from program language.
 - Negative Keyword Analysis
 - No explicit negative signals tied to Religion/Metaphysical Foundations in the public materials; no secularization framing observed.
 - Why this rating
 - The materials anchor religious/metaphysical foundations at the center of identity and pedagogy, with explicit references to transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable through a theological lens) and a liturgical/community dimension. This is strongly Classicist in the religious-metaphysical sense and aligns with Positive keywords such as “the Logos,” “sacred tradition,” and “liturgical life” (as reflected in the Six Elements framework). The absence of secular signals supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: distinct Christian ministry and Great Commission framing: ; Word of God and worship references: ; liturgy language: ; denominational posture:

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Emphasis on formation and virtue (formation of character, virtue) and the aim toward wisdom; emphasis on Truth/Goodness/Beauty as real and knowable. Public materials articulate formation as central, not mere information.
 - Foundational claims about forming humans (not solely preparing for work) and the aim toward human excellence, moral imagination, and love of learning.
 - Explicit language that education should be formation (paideia-like) and that truth/goodness/beauty are real. Positive keywords from Six Elements include “formation,” “virtue,” “human flourishing,” “great conversation,” “the true, the good, the beautiful.” SCCS content supports formation and virtue language (e.g., moral excellence, virtue lists).
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, character, integrity, wisdom, love of learning, truth/-goodness/beauty, contemplation/scholé, great conversation, moral imagination, liberal education, life-long formation.
 - Approximate hits: 7–12 core items drawn from program language and the “historic Christian education” framing.
- Negative Keyword Analysis
 - No explicit signals of “workforce readiness” or “career-technical formation” dominating; the emphasis remains formation/virtue/wisdom.
- Why this rating
 - The school’s stated aims are aligned with formation and virtue central to classical pedagogy, with emphasis on virtue formation and the “true, good, beautiful” as real. This is CLASSICAL by alignment with the Positive keyword lists in Six Essentials.

Citations: formation/virtue language and Great Commission framing: ; formation over information and virtue wording:

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum explicitly centers the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as core, with theology, moral philosophy, and natural philosophy; the Arts and physical education are included as part of the core humanities. This is a direct fit with the liberal-arts/trivium/quadrivium framework.
 - The Biblical Trivium is described in public materials (Knowledge, Understanding, Wisdom), and the Historic Christian Curriculum (Core Curricula: Humanities—Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; Theology; Moral Philosophy & Law; Natural Philosophy; The Arts; PE).
 - The High/Upper School program includes structured classical components (literature, rhetoric, classical history, logical reasoning, eloquence, memory work, etc.), indicating sustained classical

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- elements through grades.
 - Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books (documented in context as “core curricula of historic humanities”), classical studies, memory/recitation, Lectio Divina, progymnasia (memory- and rhetoric-oriented pedagogy), canonical history sequences (Western/Christendom), structure around classical language roots (Lingua Latina/Greek/Latin roots).
 - Approximate hits: 10–15 core items drawn from curriculum sections and the Biblical Trivium description.
 - Negative Keyword Analysis
 - The sources reviewed emphasize a classical/historic approach rather than a modern, project-based, or strictly STEM-first approach. There is some modern features (e.g., technology use in the classroom) but not at the scale that would signal a shift away from classical content; no explicit “social studies” redefinition away from history is observed.
 - Why this rating
 - The explicit emphasis on Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; Historic Christian humanities core; Great Books/primary sources paradigm (as part of “Great Conversation” and canonical study) and the Biblical Trivium support CLASSICAL.

Citations: core curricula (grammar/logic/rhetoric, historic humanities): Biblical Trivium (Knowledge/Understanding/Wisdom): Upper-level classical curriculum and memory/recitation (progymnasmata) in High School Program:

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogical practice includes the Biblical Trivium (Knowledge/Understanding/Wisdom) and the use of memory, recitation, and classical rhetoric across grade levels; upper school includes debates and rhetoric training; lower school emphasizes memory and singing (delightful memory): SSC materials show this through the public curriculum and specific course descriptions (e.g., Progymnasmata, Lectio Divina, classical composition, rhetoric exercises).
 - The High School program lists Progymnasmata (a classical writing/recitation tradition) and memory techniques; Lectio Divina and integrated Biblical humanities point to contemplative/orthodox practice.
 - The Student Life materials show liturgical and community-oriented practices (medieval-knighted culture celebrations, singing, and a rhythm of community life), consistent with a pedagogy that blends contemplation, memory, and public speaking.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic-tinged inquiry (explicit lower but largely through the Trivium; argument/dialectic in rhetoric), recitation/memory, progymnasmata, Lectio Divina, historical/Humanities integration, rhetoric and oratory, speeches and public speaking, singing and memory (containing the “contemplative/restful” pedagogy in parts).
 - Approximate hits: 8–12 core items.
- Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Some modern-teaching signals (e.g., technology integration) appear but do not dominate pedagogy; no explicit project-based or purely experiential-learner-dominant signals appear as the core pedagogy.
- Why this rating
 - Pedagogy aligns with classical methods (memory, recitation, progymnasmata, memory work; rhetoric training in upper grades; contemplative elements) rather than modernistic constructivism. This is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Progymnasmata, memory, Lectio Divina in High School Program: Lectio Divina and memory-based elements: Lower-school singing and memory; upper-school rhetoric/debate: Student life liturgy/cer-

emonies (Knights Fest, etc.):

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The materials describe faculty as mentors and guardians of virtue, model teachers, and “living curriculum” (describing teachers as the core of the school’s culture and as living exemplars). The “ministry of education” framing reinforces faculty as living curriculum rather than mere technicians.
 - The public materials emphasize a teacher profile and a culture of collegiality, mentorship, and virtue; the school’s own materials outline the kind of teacher they seek (deep love for God; love for children; gifting and calling to teach; training/equipping).
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers; mentors; portrait of teacher; collegial culture; moral exemplars; lifelong learning; training and equipping; giftedness and calling to teach.
 - Approximate hits: 6–10.
- Negative Keyword Analysis
 - The material that discusses faculty emphasizes classical formation and virtue; there are no explicit negative signals about faculty (e.g., “teachers as mere technicians” or a low standard). A few lines mention certification but emphasize “giftedness and calling” rather than strict certification alone.
- Why this rating
 - The “living curriculum” language and the emphasis on virtue-based mentorship and classical formation strongly align with the Classical criteria for faculty.

Citations: living curriculum and faculty as core; giftedness and calling to teach: public profile of teacher (profile/portrait) language:

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The materials emphasize partnership with parents, co-teaching dynamics, and covenant community; public materials stress that parents are co-teachers and that the school seeks to educate parents about classical education via websites/book studies/genealogy of classical education; there is an explicit emphasis on family-school-church partnership.
 - The school describes opening its doors to parents, hosting events, and inviting parent involvement; there is also a public GIVING program and a clear “ministry” posture that invites parental support.
 - Material mentions that the Great Commission drives affordability and that the school seeks to sustain a covenant-community that includes families of various economic levels, aligning with the community-faculty partnership criterion.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; seminars/-book studies; open campus; covenant Christian community; family involvement; church-family-school synergy.
 - Approximate hits: 6–10.
- Negative Keyword Analysis
 - No explicit consumer-model language; the materials emphasize partnership, not customer-dominance.
- Why this rating
 - The materials consistently present parents as essential partners in the educational project, with a robust community ethos and home–church–school integration that aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for parents/community.

Citations: partnership with parents/co-teachers/book studies/open campus: open-campus/parent involvement language: affordability/Great Commission as family/community framing:

Aggregate Ranking and Interpretation

- Overall, ECCE shows a strong alignment with CLASSICAL in all six categories. The weight of evidence across the site content demonstrates a distinctly classical Christian model (grammar/logic/rhetoric; historic Christian humanities; formation/virtue; Great Commission framing; memory/recitation, and the public persona of faculty as mentors-living curriculum; parent/Church-community partnerships). The absence of sustained signals pointing toward a non-classical, job-focused or secular approach supports a CLASSICAL classification.
- Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is identified)
 - Not applicable here, as no category is categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required in this assessment context.

What would move the needle (if applicable) - None needed. The school already demonstrates a robust Classical Christian orientation per the Six Elements rubric.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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